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Extraction

5.4.3 The following table represents the advantages and disadvantages of a number of common shift patterns which are currently employed or being proposed by major civils projects in the UK and Europe.

	12hr 7/4/7/3	8hr 7/3/7/2/7/2	8hr 5/2	12hr 5/2/4/3	12hr Continental 3/4/3/4/3/4	8hr Continental 2/2/3/2/2/3/ 2/2/3/2/2/3
Number of crews	3	4	3	2	3	4
24-hour coverage	Yes	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes
Weekends free	1 in 4	1 in 4	Every weekend	Every weekend	1 in 4	1 in 4
Weekend frequency	1 rest, 3 working 4-week rotation	1 rest, 3 working 4-week rotation	Every weekend	Every weekend	1 rest, 3 working 4-week rotation	1 rest, 3 working 4-week rotation
Shorter rest period	72 hours (3 days) Nights to days	48 hours (2 days) Nights to days	48 hours (2 days) Nights to days	72 hours (3 days) Nights to days	72 hours (3 days) Nights to days	48 hours (2 days) Nights to days
Longer rest period	120 hours (5 days) Days to nights	96 hours (4 days) Days to backs	72 hours (3 days) Days to backs & Backs to nights	72 hours (3 days) Nights to days	96 hours (4 days) Nights to Days	72 hours (3 days) Nights to days
Average Working Week	56.0	42.8	40	48	56.0	42.9
Risk of fatigue	High	Medium	Low	Medium/Low	Medium	Medium

5.5 Fixed Shift Selection

5.5.1 Fixed day shifts are not considered to be a particular risk of fatigue. Where possible, work should be undertaken on a normal working week with the weekend off. Where weekend work is required this should involve engaging with the workforce to understand the individual demands and develop a pattern to provide weekend cover.